

Family Contact and Access Policy

SECTIONS 1-4: PURPOSE, SCOPE, RESPONSIBILITIES & CONTACT ARRANGEMENTS

1 PURPOSE

To promote and support positive, safe family contact that contributes to the wellbeing, identity and stability of children and young people in accordance with Tusla, HIQA National Standards, Children First and the principle of maintaining family relationships in the child's best interests.

2 SCOPE

- ✓ All children and young people and their families/significant others
- ✓ Phone, video, in-person visits, letters and other forms of contact
- ✓ Supervised and unsupervised contact arrangements
- ✓ Balancing safety, court orders and individual needs

3 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ **Provider & PIC:** Approve contact plans and ensure resources
- ✓ **Key Workers:** Facilitate, supervise and record contact
- ✓ **Care Staff:** Support preparation and debrief
- ✓ **Management:** Review plans and resolve difficulties
- ✓ **All Staff:** Respect family relationships and maintain confidentiality

4 CONTACT ARRANGEMENTS

- ✓ Contact plans developed with the young person, family and placing authority
- ✓ Frequency, location and supervision level risk-assessed
- ✓ Court orders and legal requirements strictly followed
- ✓ Safe venues and transport arranged when needed
- ✓ Positive experiences promoted through preparation and feedback

Family Contact and Access Policy

Page 2

SECTIONS 5-7: YOUNG PERSON INVOLVEMENT, SUPERVISION & SUPPORT

5 YOUNG PERSON INVOLVEMENT

- ✓ Views of the child central to contact planning
- ✓ Refusals or difficulties explored sensitively
- ✓ Feedback after contact sought and acted upon
- ✓ Age-appropriate explanation of arrangements
- ✓ Advocacy offered where needed

6 SUPERVISION & RISK MANAGEMENT

- ✓ Supervision levels determined by risk assessment
- ✓ Clear guidelines for supervised contact sessions
- ✓ Immediate action on any concerns during contact
- ✓ Safe handover procedures
- ✓ Recording of all contact sessions

7 SUPPORT MEASURES

- ✓ Preparation and debrief support for young person and family
- ✓ Family support services signposted
- ✓ Difficulties addressed through mediation or review meetings
- ✓ Impact on placement stability monitored
- ✓ Positive family relationships celebrated

Family Contact and Access Policy

SECTIONS 8-10: RECORDING, MONITORING & POLICY REVIEW

8 RECORDING & COMPLIANCE

- ✓ Accurate records of all contact maintained
- ✓ Confidentiality and information sharing protocols followed
- ✓ Staff trained in family work
- ✓ Immediate action on breaches or concerns
- ✓ Compliance with court orders and Tusla requirements

9 MONITORING & REVIEW

- ✓ Audits of contact plans and records
- ✓ Feedback from young people and families
- ✓ Feedback from young people and families
- ✓ Analysis of contact frequency and quality
- ✓ Compliance with individual plans reviewed
- ✓ Staff supervision includes family work

10 POLICY REVIEW

- ✓ Reviewed annually or sooner if required
- ✓ Incorporates feedback and regulatory changes
- ✓ Considers trends in contact issues
- ✓ Reviewed policy approved by Registered Provider and communicated to all staff
- ✓ Superseded versions archived per record management procedures